FDAC · FREE 3-PAGE GUIDE

Foundations of Fitness and Health Metrics

Your complete guide to getting started with health data. Plain language. No medical background required.

The four numbers that matter most

Most wearable apps surface dozens of metrics. Four of them carry the most signal for healthy aging — and they are the four we focus the rest of this course around. Read each card below for what it is, why it matters, and the rough target ranges to start with.

1. Resting heart rate (RHR)

Your heart's baseline beats-per-minute when you're calm. A lower RHR usually means a stronger, more efficient cardiovascular system. Healthy adult ranges land between roughly 50 and 80 BPM, with trained athletes often below 50.

2. Daily steps

A simple, durable proxy for movement. The often-quoted 10,000-step goal is more convention than science — what matters more is the trend: are you trending up week-over- week, or sliding down? Pick a baseline that fits your life and aim for steady increase.

3. Sleep quality (not just quantity)

Hours in bed is necessary but not sufficient. Sleep efficiency (% of in-bed time actually asleep), wake-after-sleep-onset, and time spent in deep + REM stages tell a richer story. Most consumer wearables now estimate these reasonably well.

4. Intensity minutes

How long you spend at moderate or vigorous heart rate. The current evidence-based target is 150 moderate + 75 vigorous minutes per week — the dose linked to ~50% lower all-cause mortality in cohort studies.

Reading your body's daily signals

Numbers in isolation are noise. Numbers in context tell a story.

Three rules for reading your wearable data

Rule 1 · Trend over today

Single-day numbers fluctuate with caffeine, alcohol, stress, hydration, and the placement of your wearable. The seven-day rolling average filters that noise. When you check your metrics, look at the trend line first, today's value second.

Rule 2 · Direction over absolute value

A resting heart rate of 68 BPM is neither "good" nor "bad" in isolation. What matters is which direction it's moving. RHR trending down over weeks and months is one of the clearest signals that your training is working.

Rule 3 · One change at a time

When a metric moves, change one input — sleep schedule, hydration, training load — and give it two weeks before you change anything else. This is how you learn what actually works for your body, instead of guessing.

> **The 80/20 of intensity minutes**
>
> Hitting 150 moderate minutes weekly is mostly a scheduling problem, not a fitness one. Three 30-minute walks at a brisk pace + two slightly harder sessions clears the bar for most people. The course covers exactly how to dial this in for your equipment and your schedule.

Your first two weeks

A short on-ramp anyone with a wearable can run this week.

Days 1–3 · Establish baseline

Wear the device every day, do nothing different.

- Capture resting heart rate (morning, before coffee).
- Capture daily steps without aiming at any number.
- Capture sleep efficiency and total time asleep.
- Note any intensity minutes you happen to accumulate.

Days 4–7 · Pick one lever

Choose one metric to nudge. For most people the highest-leverage starting point is sleep: consistent bedtime + 7 hours minimum. Track for the rest of week 1.

Days 8–14 · Add intensity minutes

Layer in 3 walks of 25 minutes at brisk pace. Pace is brisk if you can speak in short phrases but not full sentences. Your wearable will start logging moderate intensity minutes on these. Don't worry about hitting 150/75 in week 2 — half is fine.

> **What comes next**
>
> FDAC is the 5-week course that builds on these foundations: device validation, pattern recognition, intensity-minute dialing, long-term trend interpretation, and a personal optimization protocol. Enrollment opens after you're on the waitlist.
>
> Brand Anthony McDonald · fdac.witus.online · centenarianos.com